

KANNAN APPIYA SANTHARAM

Senior Lead Software Engineer (Frontend/Fullstack) | React · Node.js · AI-Native Engineering

Chennai, India

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Nationality: Indian | **Notice Period:** 60 Days

PROFILE

Full-stack Senior Lead Software Engineer with 10.5+ years in enterprise SaaS, working across React and Node.js. Currently leading an engineering team on a platform serving 4,000+ MSP and IT enterprise customers, focused on AI-native engineering with LLM orchestration, MCP servers, and production agent skills. Seeking a Senior Lead Software Engineer / Engineering Manager role.

BUSINESS IMPACT SNAPSHOT

- An AI test-authoring platform generates, runs, and self-heals end-to-end suites, converting recurring QA cost into automated coverage.
- A headless Base UI design system built on customised design tokens, paired with a custom Claude Code skill that generates components straight from a Figma node link, took page build-out from 2 days of AI-assisted engineering to a few hours.
- 96% faster builds: 2-minute cold starts cut to 5 seconds across 12 packages, reclaiming hundreds of engineering hours a month.
- 4,000+ enterprise customers: platform-wide migrations, dead-code removal, and regression automation delivered without disrupting the platform.
- 30,000+ lines of dead code retired: smaller maintenance footprint and lower security overhead.
- Team capacity multiplied: squad leadership plus mentorship of 10+ engineers across SuperOps and Freshworks, shortening ramp-up time.

SKILLS

Leadership & Delivery: Engineering Squad Leadership, Developer Mentorship (10+ engineers), Architecture & Code Reviews, Agile Delivery, Cross-Team Collaboration, Stakeholder & Customer Communication

AI-Native Engineering: Production Agent Skills, Model Context Protocol (MCP) Servers, LLM Orchestration, Agent Write-Scope Safety, RAG & Embedding, Amazon Bedrock AgentCore

Platform & Performance: Monorepos, Module Federation, Rspack & Webpack 5, Micro-Frontends, Design Systems & UI SDKs, Core Web Vitals

Full Stack Engineering: React, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Node.js, Python, REST API Design & Integration, GraphQL & Apollo, Zustand, Playwright, Jenkins CI/CD, Docker, AWS

Tools: Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Figma MCP, Knip Static Analysis, Git & GitHub Flow

WORK EXPERIENCE

SUPEROPS

Senior Lead Software Engineer

Chennai, India

Jul 2022 – Present

Progression: Senior Software Engineer › Lead Software Engineer › Senior Lead Software Engineer

- Own frontend delivery for a platform serving 4,000+ MSP and IT enterprise customers, leading a squad through sprint planning, architecture review, and cross-functional execution with product and design teams to keep enterprise feature commitments on schedule.
- Cut cold-start build compilation by 96%, from 2 minutes to 5 seconds, via a solo Webpack 5 to Rspack migration delivered in 3 weeks across 12 monorepo packages, reclaiming hundreds of engineering hours per month and accelerating time-to-market for every downstream feature.
- Reduced manual regression effort and release risk by architecting an AI test-authoring platform in React and Node.js that orchestrates LLM agents to generate, execute, and self-heal end-to-end test suites, streaming real-time results over HTTP Web Streams.
- Raised team throughput by putting custom Claude Code skills and MCP servers into production developer workflow, with multi-tier write-scope guardrails that let engineers adopt autonomous agents without exposing core platform interfaces to risk.

- Built a Python MCP server exposing tool calls over a queryable graph of the frontend codebase, now consumed by AI tooling across other engineering teams.
- Built a headless Base UI design system on customised design tokens and authored a Claude Code skill that generates production components from a Figma node link via MCP, cutting page build time from 2 days of AI-assisted engineering to a few hours.
- Lowered total cost of ownership by eliminating 30,000+ lines of dead code and unused dependencies, shrinking the monorepo's maintenance, build, and security surface.
- Improved user-perceived performance across the product through route-level code splitting, React lazy loading (Suspense), and a per-package chunking strategy.
- Maintained platform health with a 300+ test-case Playwright regression suite in Jenkins CI, catching regressions before release.
- Unlocked enterprise-tier requirements by delivering role-based access control (RBAC) and near-real-time operational dashboards, tuning custom cached Apollo hooks to balance data freshness against network load.
- Removed duplicated build effort by standardising a reusable UI SDK framework adopted across product teams.
- Grew engineering capacity by mentoring 4 to 6 junior and mid-level engineers on React and monorepo quality standards, shortening ramp-up and reducing rework.

FRESHWORKS

Senior Software Engineer (Customer-Facing Engineering)

*Chennai, India
Jun 2018 – Jul 2022*

Progression: Onboarding Engineer › Senior Software Engineer

- Served as the engineering bridge to enterprise customers, partnering with Support, Customer Success, and Sales to turn complex account requirements into shipped solutions that unblocked onboarding and renewals.
- Reduced support handling effort by building a Customer 360 dashboard consolidating support, sales, and account data into a single operational view.
- Widened platform fit in competitive enterprise deals by integrating tier-1 SaaS systems including Jira, Salesforce, Zendesk, and ServiceNow through robust REST API services.
- Closed customer-specific gaps by shipping targeted add-ons and supporting REST API services in place of one-off custom work.
- Accelerated team onboarding by mentoring 6 to 7 junior and onboarding engineers on React, REST API development, and UI architecture through structured code and design reviews.
- Shipped features end-to-end across Freshworks products, building the React UI and the Node.js REST API services behind it, so enterprise requirements landed without waiting on a separate backend team.

NICHE VIDEO MEDIA, LLC / INFIGENIC, LLC (ACQUIRED BY FRESHWORKS)

Software Developer

Chennai & Bengaluru, India | Mar 2016 – Jun 2018

Progression: Web Application Developer & Designer › Software Developer

- Increased self-serve revenue capture with an admin dashboard that dynamically priced Stripe plans across feature selection, storage tiers, and bandwidth limits.
- Strengthened product differentiation by building video player customisation from scratch, with configurable controls, annotations, and call-to-action overlays driving viewer conversion.
- Built high-converting company and product landing pages supporting top-of-funnel demand.
- Extended enterprise workflow coverage by delivering a Freshservice–DocuSign integration over REST API services, joining Freshworks with the team on acquisition.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.), Computer Science

2011 – 2015

K.L.N. College of Information Technology (Affiliated with Anna University), Tamil Nadu, India

LANGUAGES

English: Fluent (Professional Working Proficiency) | **Tamil:** Native | **Hindi:** Intermediate